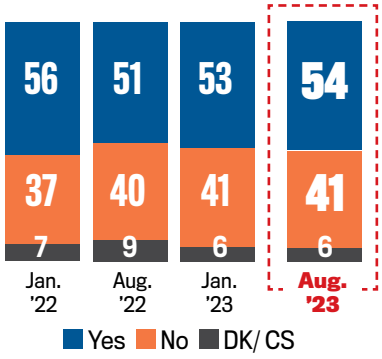
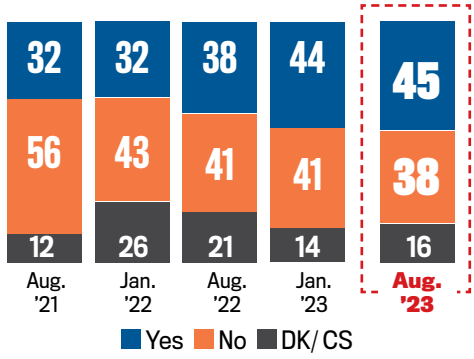
Q. Has the Modi government brought down corruption in India?



More than half believe that the Modi government has minimised corruption

A larger number this time think the govt misuses central agencies more than its predecessors

Q. Do you think the BJP government misuses central agencies such as the ED, CBI and I-T department more than other governments?



All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS: don't know/can't say

ally in Odisha and Assam but could add more seats in Uttar Pradesh. INDIA, on the other hand, sees massive gains in Maharashtra and Bihar, but surprisingly the Congress wins in the Karnataka and Himachal Pradesh assembly polls do not fetch the party any dividends in the parliamentary polls. The BJP is likely to win most of Karnataka's 28 Lok Sabha seats and Himachal's four, like it did last time. The MOTN poll also indicates that even if the Congress wins Madhya Pradesh and retains Chhattisgarh and Rajasthan later this year, it is unlikely to impact the Lok Sabha voting patterns in favour of the BJP. The party is projected to sweep most of the seats in these three states that account for 65 Lok Sabha seats—just like it did in 2019, after the Congress had won the assembly elections in these states the previous year. However, if the members of INDIA do go for pre-poll seat-sharing, they may gain in states like Kerala, West Bengal and marginally in UP. A mere 15-seat margin over the majority mark is something the BJP cannot be comfortable with because a decline in seats in even a few states could see it fall below the majority number, which is likely to make it vulnerable to coalition compulsions.



DR P.K. MISHRA
Principal Secretary to the PM

"The PM has already laid a strong foundation for the development of India. In the next five years, he plans to further strengthen it and work towards economic growth to achieve by 2047 the vision of a developed nation that is inclusive, integrated and progressive"

While Modi and the BJP remain frontrunners in the race to win the 2024 Lok Sabha election, there are enough caveats in the MOTN findings for both sides to take note of. On the positive side for the BJP, when asked to list the single biggest achievement of the Modi government, 21.1 per cent gave top billing to its handling of the Covid-19 pandemic. That is creditable given the enormous stress the country came under during the pandemic's first and second waves, with the government even faltering at times. Overall, though, Modi and his government seem to have won popular appreciation for the way they shepherded the country through one of the world's worst crises. The second in the list of this government's achievements is the perception of it being relatively corruption-free, with 12.7 per cent listing it as their top choice. Modi reiterated his clean record in his I-Day speech, a stark contrast to the perception of a scam-ridden UPA in the final year of its second term. The revocation of Article 370 and the Ram temple in Ayodhya appear in third and fourth place, respectively, suggesting that the core BJP voter is happy with Modi's track record. These three factors—handling of Covid, corruption-free governance and advancing the Hindutva agenda—are also likely to be Modi's chief electoral planks, in addition to welfare schemes and infrastructure development.